Code-Guided Video Editing with Source-Grounded Executable Proxies

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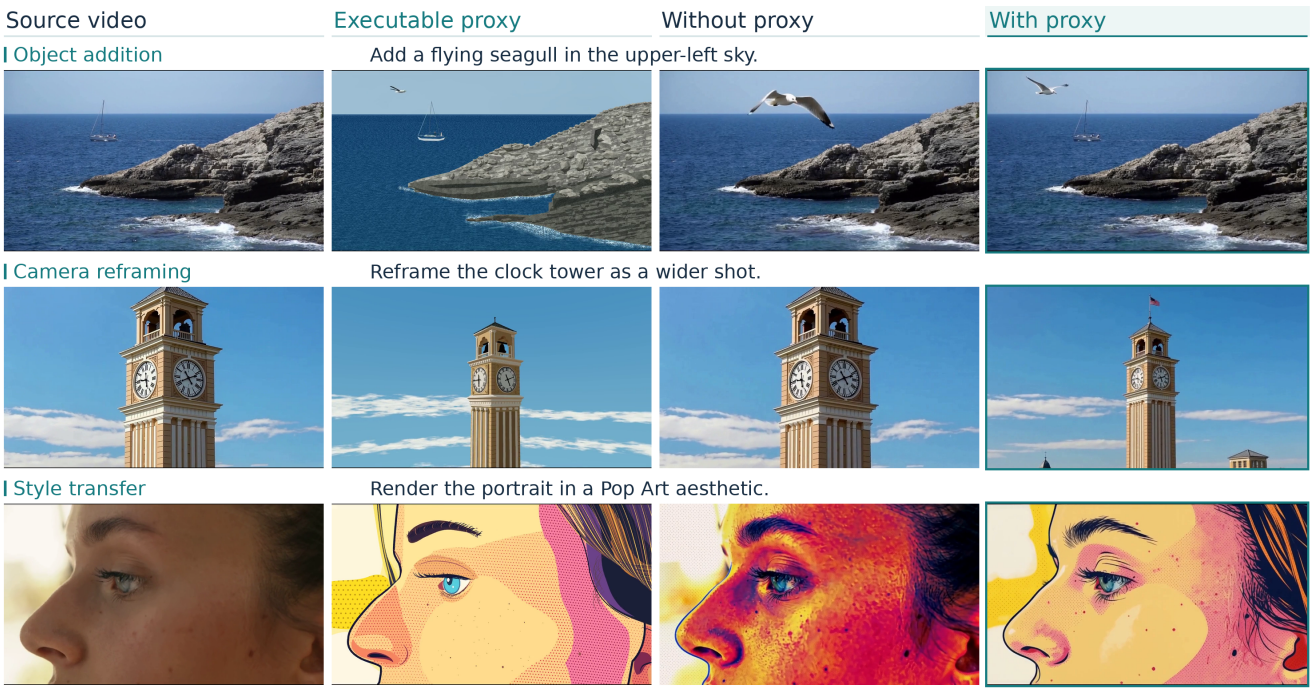

Figure 1. **Executable proxies for source-video editing.** Rows show object addition, camera reframing, and Pop Art stylization. Each row compares the source, rendered proxy, and matched outputs without and with early-step proxy guidance. In these examples, guidance improves object scale, realizes the wider composition, and produces the requested graphic treatment. All views within a row are time-aligned.

Abstract

Source-video editing must coordinate changes to scene content, framing, and motion with the appearance and timing of the original footage. Language instructions describe the intended operation, but its spatial and temporal arrangement must still be instantiated in the observed scene. We formulate this instantiation through executable scene programs: Video2Code *estimates the source scene,* next-code prediction *specifies its edited successor, and* Code2Video *realizes the program through video synthesis. Our training-free implementation uses one multimodal coding agent to jointly ground and edit the program, whose render provides an inspectable proxy of the target scene. A frozen MiniMax-H3 generator retains the source reference throughout sampling while the proxy participates only in early steps to communicate the requested intervention. On 365 paired OpenVE-Bench cases, proxy guidance outperforms the no-proxy baseline in category-macro score (2.84 versus 2.74) using three Gemini 3.1 Pro (preview) judgments per output. The largest gains occur in text and subtitles, camera editing, and object addition.*

1. Introduction

Generative video editing draws on learned visual priors [10, 22] to change scene content while retaining information from observed footage. FateZero reuses source attention, and TokenFlow propagates corresponding diffusion features to maintain consistency during editing [7, 21]. AnyV2V and VACE further develop reference-conditioned interfaces for video creation and editing [12, 14]. Consider a request to add a bird in the upper-left sky: the bird needs a location, scale, and trajectory, while the coastline, camera motion, and action timing should remain unchanged throughout the shot.

In a reference-conditioned editor, the source clip and the instruction represent the editing problem in different forms: pixels encode the scene, while words specify the operation. The generator must ground that operation in the observed scene as it produces the edited video, including the object's placement and behavior over time. An editable visual plan would expose these decisions before synthesis and allow their consequences to be inspected independently of the generated appearance.

An approximate scene can still make the intended change explicit. We therefore represent the target scene with an executable program that places entities, configures a camera, and evaluates their attributes and motion at specified times. The program is the editable representation, and its rendered proxy reveals the spatial and temporal consequences of the instruction (Fig. 1). A requested object can be placed relative to existing geometry, a camera can be reframed, and a material can be changed through the same programmatic interface. The source footage remains the visual reference for details beyond the procedural approximation.

We organize this interface as *Video2Code*, *next-code prediction*, and *Code2Video*, with each stage exposing the information needed by the next. Video2Code estimates the source scene on which the instruction acts; next-code prediction specifies its edited successor, whose render conditions video realization. Our training-free implementation jointly performs source grounding and program editing in one multimodal coding-agent session, which directly produces the edited program. The agent executes and visually refines this program so that the resulting proxy expresses the requested intervention before the video model runs.

Code Video Model provides the closest foundation through executable video previews and early-step proxy conditioning [15]. Its synthesis interface pairs a program-rendered proxy with an appearance reference image; we construct the edited program from observed footage and use the source video as the persistent reference. This adaptation grounds the intervention in the video's existing composition and timeline, with the source conditioning every sampling step and the proxy conditioning only the early steps. The MiniMax-H3 generator [17] and its encoders remain frozen, so the interface requires no additional model training.

On 365 paired OpenVE-Bench cases [8], our proxy-guided editor outperforms the no-proxy baseline in category-macro score (2.84 versus 2.74), using three Gemini 3.1 Pro (preview) judgments per output. The largest gains occur in text and subtitles, camera editing, and object addition, where the program can express graphical changes and spatial arrangements directly. Selected comparisons show the resulting control over bird scale, wider framing, and graphic stylization, with the proxy and both generated outputs visible at matching timestamps.

Our contributions are:

- An executable representation that organizes source-video editing through scene reconstruction, program transition, and video realization (Sec. 3.1).
- A training-free implementation that grounds an edited program in observed footage and combines its proxy with persistent source conditioning (Sec. 3).
- A paired benchmark study with repeated judgments, equal-weight category aggregation, and visual inspection of intermediate programs and generated outputs (Sec. 4).

2. Related Work

Source preservation in video editing. Tune-A-Video adapts an image diffusion model to a source video through one-shot tuning [26]. FateZero and TokenFlow preserve source information through attention reuse and propagation of diffusion features, respectively [7, 21]. FLATTEN introduces optical-flow-guided attention, while RAVE combines frame interactions with randomized noise shuffling [4, 13]. CoDeF represents canonical content and temporal deformation to propagate image edits through a video [20]. AnyV2V combines an edited first frame with feature injection into an image-to-video model [14]. These approaches inform how source information can persist during editing. We study an additional interface: an executable target-scene program whose render communicates the requested intervention to a video generator.

Structured conditions for visual synthesis. Structure- and content-guided generation separates conditioning signals for these two aspects of video synthesis [5]. ControlNet learns spatial control from conditions such as edges, depth, and pose [29], while VideoComposer combines text, spatial constraints, and temporal conditions for video synthesis [24]. MotionCtrl and CameraCtrl provide explicit interfaces for object or camera motion [9, 25]. ReVideo combines first-frame content editing with trajectory-based motion control [18], and VACE unifies references, video inputs, and masks for creation and editing [12]. Our rendered proxy encodes object layout, camera configuration, motion, and semantic changes in one visual condition. We

use the reference-conditioned MiniMax-H3 model for video realization [17].

Executable visual representations. Holodeck generates three-dimensional environments from language and spatial constraints [28]; BlenderAlchemy uses visual feedback to search over graphics-editing actions [11]. The Scene Language combines programs, semantic descriptions, and identity embeddings [30], and Code-as-World studies executable representations for physical reasoning [23]. Code2Video generates educational animations through executable code [2]. Code2Video-Compass evaluates code-based generation from text, image, and video inputs [3], alongside recent open-model efforts in code-driven video creation [19]. These works motivate programs as representations that can be executed, inspected, and revised.

Code Video Model is the closest foundation for our implementation [15]. It renders programs into video previews, guides synthesis with a proxy and an appearance reference, and introduces early-step conditioning to limit transfer of the proxy's rendered appearance. Its applications also include scene editing. We reuse this mechanism in an observed-video setting: source footage grounds program construction and remains a persistent reference during synthesis. The Video2Code–next-code–Code2Video formulation organizes this source estimation, intervention, and realization interface.

Editing data and evaluation. InstructPix2Pix learns instruction-based image editing from generated pairs [1]. InsViE-1M constructs and filters video-editing triplets for training an instruction-following editor [27]. OpenVE-3M provides editing data and OpenVE-Bench, which spans eight editing tasks [8]. OmniEdit-Bench and VEFX-Bench further examine video-specific coverage, instruction fidelity, and content preservation [6, 16]. We adopt OpenVE-Bench's task-specific rubrics, average repeated judgments, and report equal-weight category aggregation. Executable intermediates additionally allow us to inspect whether a failure arises before or after the intended edit is expressed in the proxy.

3. Method

Given a source video and an editing instruction, we construct an executable scene that makes the intervention visible before its final appearance is synthesized. The edited program supplies a rendered proxy, and a frozen video model combines that proxy with the source to realize the edit (Fig. 2).

3.1. Editing as a program transition

Let $V_{\mathrm{src}} = \{I_i\}_{i=0}^{N-1}$ denote a source video and e an editing instruction. We describe editing through a source scene program P_0, its edited successor P_1, and a video realization:

$$P_0 = \mathcal{A}_{\mathrm{rec}}(V_{\mathrm{src}}), \tag{1}$$

$$P_1 = \mathcal{A}_{\mathrm{next}}(P_0, e; V_{\mathrm{src}}), \tag{2}$$

$$V_{\mathrm{proxy}} = \mathcal{R}(P_1), \tag{3}$$

$$V_{\mathrm{edit}} = \mathcal{G}(V_{\mathrm{src}}, e, V_{\mathrm{proxy}}). \tag{4}$$

Here $\mathcal{A}_{\mathrm{rec}}$ estimates scene structure, $\mathcal{A}_{\mathrm{next}}$ specifies an instruction-conditioned program transition, $\mathcal{R}$ executes and renders a program, and $\mathcal{G}$ is a frozen reference-conditioned video model. Each program describes a scene over the full video timeline; P_0 and P_1 index editing states. The rendered proxy is an observable consequence of the edited program.

Joint implementation. Equations (1)–(4) define the logical interfaces. Our prototype implements the first two jointly as $P_1 = \mathcal{A}_{\mathrm{joint}}(V_{\mathrm{src}}, e)$: a multimodal coding agent receives the source observations and instruction and directly produces the edited program. Only P_1 is retained; the experiments do not materialize or independently evaluate P_0. Figure 2 distinguishes this joint implementation from the three-stage formulation.

3.2. Video2Code: grounding the source scene

To locate the requested change in the observed scene, the program must account for visible entities, their layout and occlusions, the camera, and motion over time. The target is a procedural account sufficient to express the intervention. Unique three-dimensional geometry and complete photographic reconstruction are unnecessary for this role.

The coding agent inspects the source video through time-indexed frames and constructs a Three.js scene. Object groups and geometry represent entities; camera parameters determine the view; time-dependent transforms encode motion and event timing. Materials, lighting, and procedural effects convey semantic attributes. The source composition, viewing direction, action timing, cuts, and occlusion relationships anchor the program wherever the edit leaves them unchanged. These constraints apply to the joint source-grounding and editing session.

The task contract requires a fully procedural render. Source imagery is used for observation and is excluded from rendered textures, video backgrounds, plates, and composited overlays. Consequently, the proxy exposes a constructed scene description rather than a copy of the input pixels. The source video remains available downstream for appearance and performance that the procedural approximation does not capture.

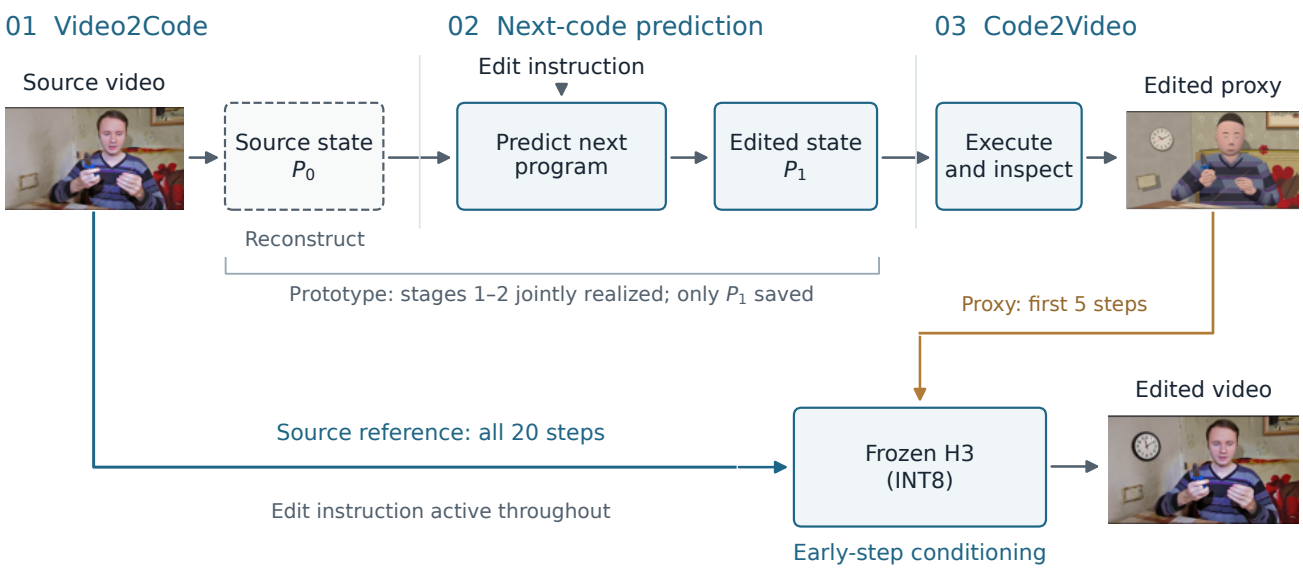

Figure 2. **Editing through executable scene programs.** Video2Code estimates the source scene, next-code prediction specifies its edited successor, and Code2Video renders the edited program to guide video synthesis. The training-free implementation jointly performs the first two stages in one coding-agent session and retains the edited program. The frozen generator uses the source and edit instruction for all 20 steps, with proxy conditioning restricted to the first five steps.

3.3. Next-code prediction: specifying the intervention

The estimated scene provides the entities and coordinates in which the editing instruction must be instantiated. The program transition expresses that intervention through changes to the executable scene. Additions introduce entities with explicit placement, scale, and behavior. Removals omit the target entity and represent the revealed context. Camera edits change the viewing configuration; stylization and creative edits modify materials, geometry, or procedural effects. The successor program retains scene relationships that remain relevant to the instruction and can rewrite code as needed.

For example, the wall-clock scene in Fig. 2 grounds the person, wall, and action timing in the source, then introduces the clock's geometry, placement, and hand animation. The program exposes both the edited scene and the parameters that determine its render. In the joint implementation, these source-grounding and intervention operations are performed within one session.

Deterministic execution and visual refinement. Every scene exposes a `seek(t)` interface that updates camera, transforms, visibility, materials, and animation at time t. The state at a timestamp must be independent of the order in which timestamps are visited. The agent renders keyframes and contact sheets, compares them with the source observations and edit request, and revises the program. The refinement contract covers composition, geometry and occlusion, motion and timing, and semantic legibility. The encoded proxy is inspected again before use. Execution checks validate resolution, frame count, silent output, and per-frame camera metadata; these establish an executable condition without guaranteeing semantic correctness.

3.4. Code2Video: realizing the edited scene

The edited program specifies the intervention, while its rendered appearance remains a procedural approximation of the source. Rendering P_1 at the normalized source timestamps gives $V_{\text{proxy}} = \{\mathcal{R}(P_1, t_i)\}_{i=0}^{N-1}$. We provide this proxy and the source as distinct video references to MiniMax-H3 [17]. The prompt identifies `<Video 1>` as the source and `<Video 2>` as the edited structural proxy. The source anchors retained appearance and performance, while the proxy communicates the requested intervention. Appendix B provides the reference-role instructions.

The source and proxy share a normalized resolution, frame rate, and timeline. Alignment padding holds the final state of both conditions, and outputs are trimmed to the source's visible interval. Appendix A gives the normalization settings.

Early-step proxy conditioning. Following Code Video Model [15], we restrict proxy conditioning to the initial sam-

pling steps. For zero-based step k, total steps K, and proxy budget K_e,

$$c_k = \begin{cases} \mathrm{Enc}(e, V_{\mathrm{src}}, V_{\mathrm{proxy}}), & 0 \le k < K_e, \\ \mathrm{Enc}(e, V_{\mathrm{src}}), & K_e \le k < K. \end{cases} \quad (5)$$

Enc includes multimodal semantic conditioning and variational autoencoder (VAE) reference conditioning. At the switch, both pathways remove the proxy while retaining source conditioning. The sampling and proxy budgets are specified in Sec. 4. The source VAE reference latent is shared across conditioning states; the edit instruction remains active throughout. Sampling follows one continuous latent trajectory, without a restart or re-noising at the switch. All generator and encoder parameters remain frozen.

4. Experiments

We compare source-conditioned generation with and without the edited proxy, then inspect the intermediate renders to characterize how the specified intervention is realized in the final video.

4.1. Experimental setup

Benchmark and coverage. OpenVE-Bench contains 431 source-video and edit-request pairs across eight tasks [8]. We evaluate the 365 pairs for which proxy construction, validation, and both output generations have completed. The remaining cases comprise 14 moderation skips and 52 unresolved proxy generation or validation cases. Eligibility is determined by pipeline completion, and every completed pair is included in the quantitative comparison. The results therefore describe the completed subset.

Matched generation. Both groups use the same normalized source, main edit request, frozen quantized MiniMax-H3, seed 42, and 20 Euler steps. The source remains a reference for all steps. The guided group additionally receives the edited proxy for the first five steps; the baseline receives no proxy. Appendices A and B specify the implementation and reference-role prompts.

Repeated judgments and aggregation. We use the official task-specific rubrics and per-response score parser, with Gemini 3.1 Pro (preview) at temperature 0.7 as the evaluator. Each judgment receives the original source video, generated output, and edit request. The proxy is excluded from evaluation inputs. For each output, we average three valid judgments, each an official mean of three rubric dimensions on a 1–5 scale. The primary metric gives equal weight to the eight category means. The secondary micro average gives equal weight to cases. Appendix D details video input, repeated calls, and rounding.

Table 1. **OpenVE-Bench paired evaluation.** Gemini 3.1 Pro (preview), three ratings per output, official task rubrics; 1–5, higher is better. Both groups use the same 365 cases. The proxy participates for the first 5 of 20 steps. The primary metric weights all eight categories equally. Δ subtracts the displayed arm means.

Task	N	No proxy	+ Proxy	Δ
Global style	55	2.43	2.38	−0.05
Local change	57	3.39	3.39	0.00
Background change	46	2.39	2.42	+0.03
Object removal	49	2.40	2.06	−0.34
Object addition	60	2.40	2.68	+0.28
Creative edit	26	3.47	3.33	−0.14
Camera edit	39	2.44	2.89	+0.45
Text and subtitles	33	3.00	3.56	+0.56
Category macro	365	**2.74**	**2.84**	**+0.10**
Sample micro	365	2.69	2.78	+0.09

4.2. Paired benchmark comparison

Proxy guidance improves the primary category-macro score from 2.74 to 2.84, a gain of 0.10 points (Table 1). The largest gains occur in text and subtitles (+0.56), camera editing (+0.45), and object addition (+0.28). These improvements are consistent with the role of an executable preview in making graphical changes, target framing, and object placement explicit. Figures 1 and 3 illustrate corresponding edits; Appendix C provides successful examples from all eight categories.

Performance varies across tasks. Background editing improves by 0.03, and local change is unchanged at the displayed precision. Global style, creative editing, and object removal decrease by 0.05, 0.14, and 0.34, respectively. The overall gain thus coexists with category-specific regressions, which motivate examining the intermediate proxy alongside the final output.

4.3. Diagnosing proxy-to-video failures

An explicit intermediate helps distinguish failure to express an edit from failure to realize an expressed edit. Figure 4 shows selected examples from the same evaluated run. Each proxy visibly expresses the relevant intervention, although the final output does not faithfully realize it.

Edit omission. The bird-removal proxy omits the target and supplies a reconstructed background, yet the guided video retains the bird; the baseline removes it. For mountain stylization, the proxy contains monochrome drawing and hatching, while the guided output largely retains a photographic appearance. In both cases, the requested change is legible before synthesis but is missing from the generated video.

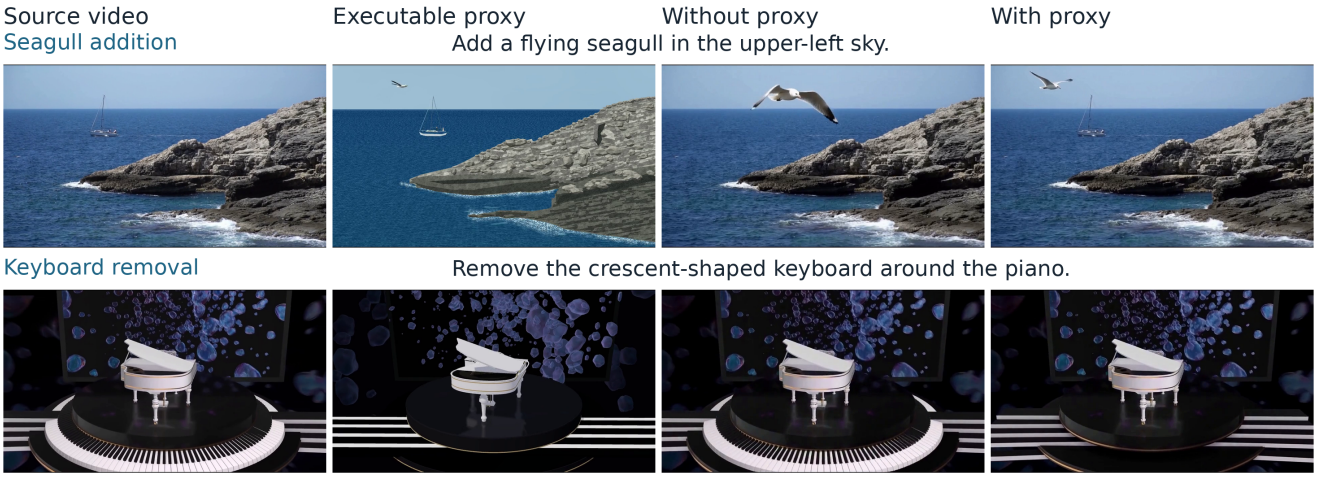

Figure 3. **Successful spatial edits.** Top: the guided seagull follows the proxy's scale and placement more closely; the baseline produces a much larger foreground bird. Bottom: the guided output removes the crescent-shaped keyboard around the piano, while the baseline retains it. The source, proxy, and both outputs are time-aligned within each row.

Partial realization. The creative-edit proxy depicts glowing jellyfish-like forms in place of snowflakes. The guided video introduces jellyfish but retains visible snowflakes alongside them. The generator follows part of the intervention while preserving source elements that the request intended to replace.

Appearance leakage. The suit-replacement proxy contains the requested gray suit and red tie. The guided video follows the clothing edit but also adopts the proxy's cartoon appearance, whereas the baseline retains a more photographic style. Restricting proxy guidance to five steps therefore does not eliminate unwanted appearance transfer in every case.

These observations identify concrete failures at the proxy-to-video interface. A legible edit specification can coexist with an unsuccessful final result, through either insufficient adherence or excessive transfer of approximate proxy appearance. The selected cases characterize these behaviors; their prevalence and underlying causes require further study.

5. Discussion and Limitations

Learning to follow an executable edit. The results distinguish the capacity to specify an intervention from the capacity to synthesize it faithfully. In Fig. 4, the desired change is already visible in the proxy, but the generator can omit it or inherit unwanted rendering traits. The pretrained H3 model remains frozen throughout our study and receives no adaptation to these source–edited-proxy pairs. A natural next step is to learn how to use the proxy's intended intervention while retaining appearance and performance from the source. Learned spatial control provides a precedent for exploiting explicit conditions [29]. Whether proxy-aware adaptation resolves the observed video-editing failures must be established through training and held-out evaluation; the present diagnostics do not isolate the cause of every regression.

Structured editing data. The prototype records tuples $(V_{\mathrm{src}}, e, P_1, V_{\mathrm{proxy}}, V_{\mathrm{edit}})$, linking an instruction, an executable edited scene, and its generative realization. Materializing and validating the source program would extend these to $(V_{\mathrm{src}}, e, P_0, P_1, V_{\mathrm{proxy}}, V_{\mathrm{edit}})$ and expose the program transition itself. Such records could support learning video-to-program reconstruction, instruction-conditioned program editing, and proxy-conditioned synthesis. Programs also provide object, camera, and temporal metadata alongside their renders. Training targets would require independent quality screening: a successful render does not ensure a successful edit, and generated targets remain pseudo-labels until validated. The importance of data construction and filtering is established in instruction-based image and video editing [1, 8, 27].

Scope of the evidence. A procedural proxy approximates scene structure and may miss source details or behavior. Its execution checks do not establish semantic correctness. The quantitative comparison covers 365 completed pairs from a 431-case benchmark, so unresolved construction and moderation can introduce selection bias. It also uses one video generator, one generation seed, and one automated evaluator. Repeating judgments reduces dependence on an individual response but does not measure variation across generated samples or establish statistical significance.

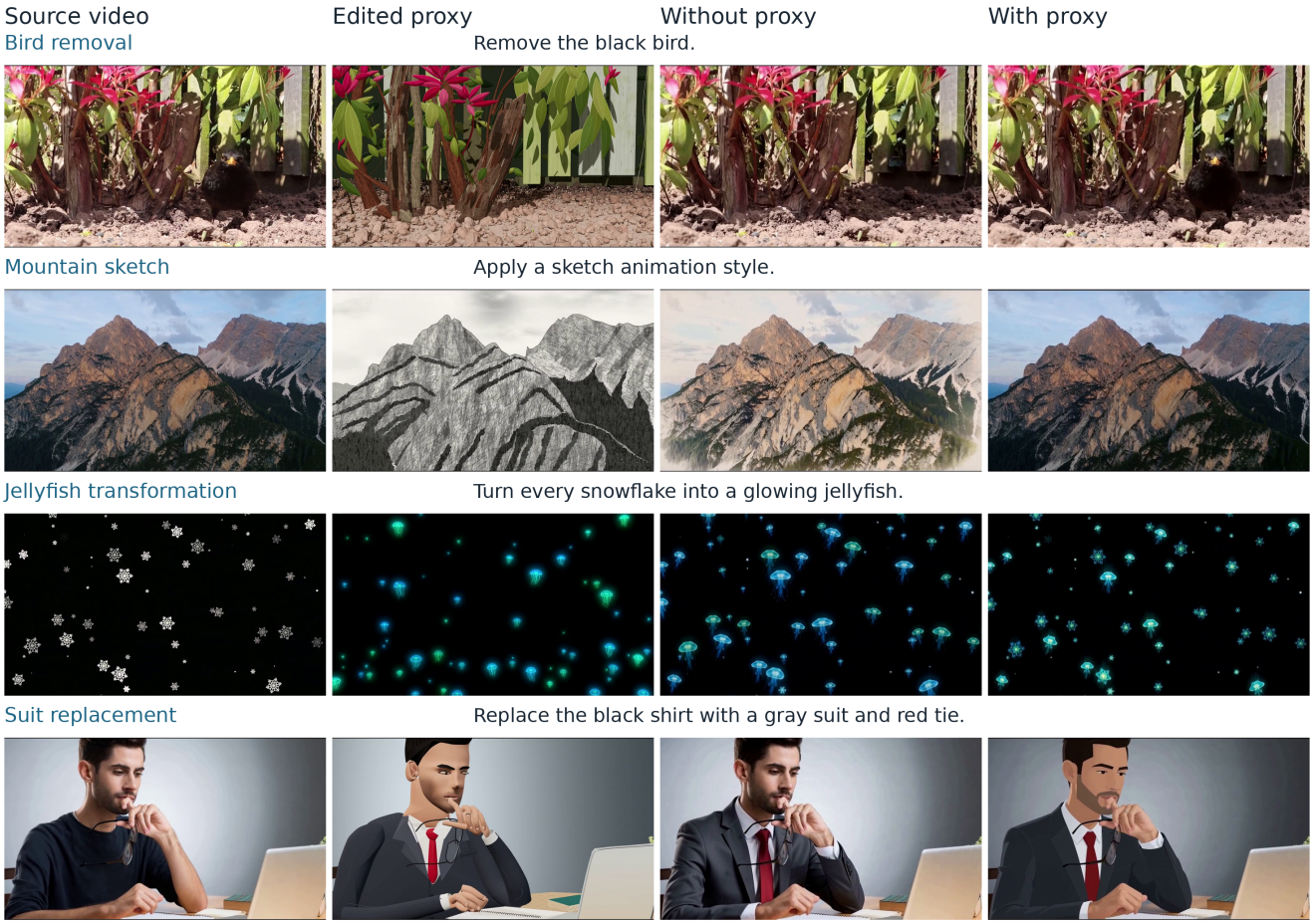

Figure 4. **A gap between edit specification and realization.** From top to bottom: the proxy omits the bird but the guided output retains it; the mountain proxy's sketch treatment is largely absent from the generated result; jellyfish coexist with retained snowflakes; and the requested suit appears together with unwanted cartoon styling. All examples use the evaluated run in Table 1. Appendix Fig. 9 provides additional timestamps.

The selected visual examples explain observable behavior rather than its frequency. Further evaluation should complete benchmark coverage, include multiple seeds and human judgments, and measure program-construction cost. Editing-specific protocols support separating instruction fidelity, preservation, realism, and consistency [6, 16]. Evaluating source reconstruction, program editing, and video realization separately would further clarify where improvements are needed.

6. Conclusion

We studied executable scene programs as an intermediate representation for source-video editing. The Video2Code–next-code–Code2Video formulation separates source grounding, intervention specification, and video realization. A training-free prototype jointly grounds and edits a program, then uses its rendered proxy to condition a frozen generator alongside the source. On 365 completed OpenVE-Bench pairs, repeated Gemini 3.1 Pro (preview) judgments yield a 0.10-point category-macro gain, with the largest gains in text and subtitles, camera editing, and object addition. Diagnostic cases show that a change expressed by the program can still be omitted, partially realized, or accompanied by unwanted appearance transfer. This gap motivates learning the interface between executable edit specifications and video synthesis.

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A. Implementation and Figure Provenance

Program construction. Our implementation adapts the Code Video Model program-and-render workflow to observed source videos. The three-stage formulation separates source reconstruction from prediction of the edited program at the representation level. The existing prototype gives the source and instruction jointly to the agent and serializes only P_1, together with its rendered proxy. It does not run two independently checkpointed coding modules or save a standalone pre-edit P_0 reconstruction. The coding stage uses the Codex CLI with GPT-6 Astra and the `xhigh` reasoning setting. Each case has its own procedural Three.js workspace, source-frame index, rendering helper, and task contract. The agent renders and directly inspects keyframes and encoded-video contact sheets. The renderer evaluates frame i at time $i/24$ through a deterministic `window.reconstruction.seek(t)` interface. A camera-state accessor exports position, quaternion, and field of view after the corresponding time has been evaluated. This metadata is used to validate the procedural output. It is not supplied as a separate camera-control tensor to the video model.

Video synthesis. We use the INT8 H3 implementation from the existing early-step experiment, with a quantized Qwen visual-language encoder. Video-VAE and audio-VAE computation use the established FP16 and FP32 paths, respectively. Sampling uses 20 Euler steps, seed 42, video/audio shifts of 12/3, and the unchanged sigma schedule of that experiment. Both multimodal semantic conditioning and VAE reference conditioning switch from source-plus-proxy to source-only after the fifth step. There is one continuing audiovisual latent trajectory. The source reference latent is shared across the full and reduced conditioning states. All parameters remain frozen.

For throughput, the existing experiment used eight resident single-GPU workers to generate independent cases. This is case-level parallelism; one video does not require the eight workers to participate in a single distributed forward pass. Figure construction only decodes existing videos and does not run H3 again.

Timeline and audio. Source videos are normalized to 24 FPS and proportionally resized and padded to 960×544. If the normalized source has N frames, alignment uses the smallest admissible $N' \geq N$ satisfying $N' = 17m+5$. The additional $N' - N$ frames hold the final source and proxy states. The displayed edited videos are trimmed to the original N-frame interval. Proxies are silent. Generated audio is retained in the original experiment outputs; the present figures and qualitative descriptions concern visual editing.

Showcase selection. The figures use outputs from the `openve_h3_int8_early_step_20261031` experiment. Existing automated judgments were used to shortlist candidates, followed by direct visual inspection of the source, proxy, and both output groups. Selection targets successful illustrations of the requested edits. It is not a random benchmark sample. The successful gallery illustrates seagull addition, crescent keyboard removal, person aging, newsroom replacement, clock tower reframing, a celestial portal, Pop Art stylization, and subtitle removal. The method diagram uses wall clock addition. The same generated output is used wherever a case appears more than once.

Image construction. The supplied figure script decodes exact frame indices from the published source, proxy, and both generated MP4s. It preserves the full normalized frame and aspect ratio, then arranges the images with external labels. No image-generation model, retouching, or replacement of visual content is used in making the figures. Figure 5 provides additional timestamps for the seagull and portal examples. The accompanying `research/showcase_provenance.json` records video hashes, sampled frame indices, timestamps, prompt hashes, and figure hashes. Figure edit summaries are paraphrases for readability; they are not additional instructions supplied during generation. The benchmark table and diagnostic figures are audited separately in `research/openve_repeat3_results.json` and `research/diagnostic_provenance.json`.

B. Conditioning Instructions

Coding-agent task contract. The task provides the source video, timestamped observations, the benchmark edit request, and exact output metadata. Its core requirements are to build a deterministic, fully procedural, editable Three.js scene; implement the requested edit; and retain unedited composition, geometry, occlusion, motion, cuts, and timing. Source imagery is available for observation only. External visual assets and source imagery are not used as rendered textures, plates, overlays, or masks. The contract also requires visual refinement passes covering composition, geometry and occlusion, motion and timing, and semantic legibility. The final encoded video is inspected before it is accepted as a condition.

Reference roles in H3. The no-proxy comparison uses the same source and main editing request, with a reference-role block that identifies only the source video. The proxy-guided group adds the second reference as described below. The original edit request is followed by the source-reference guidance below. This is the reference-role block used in the existing proxy-conditioned showcase runs; it introduces no

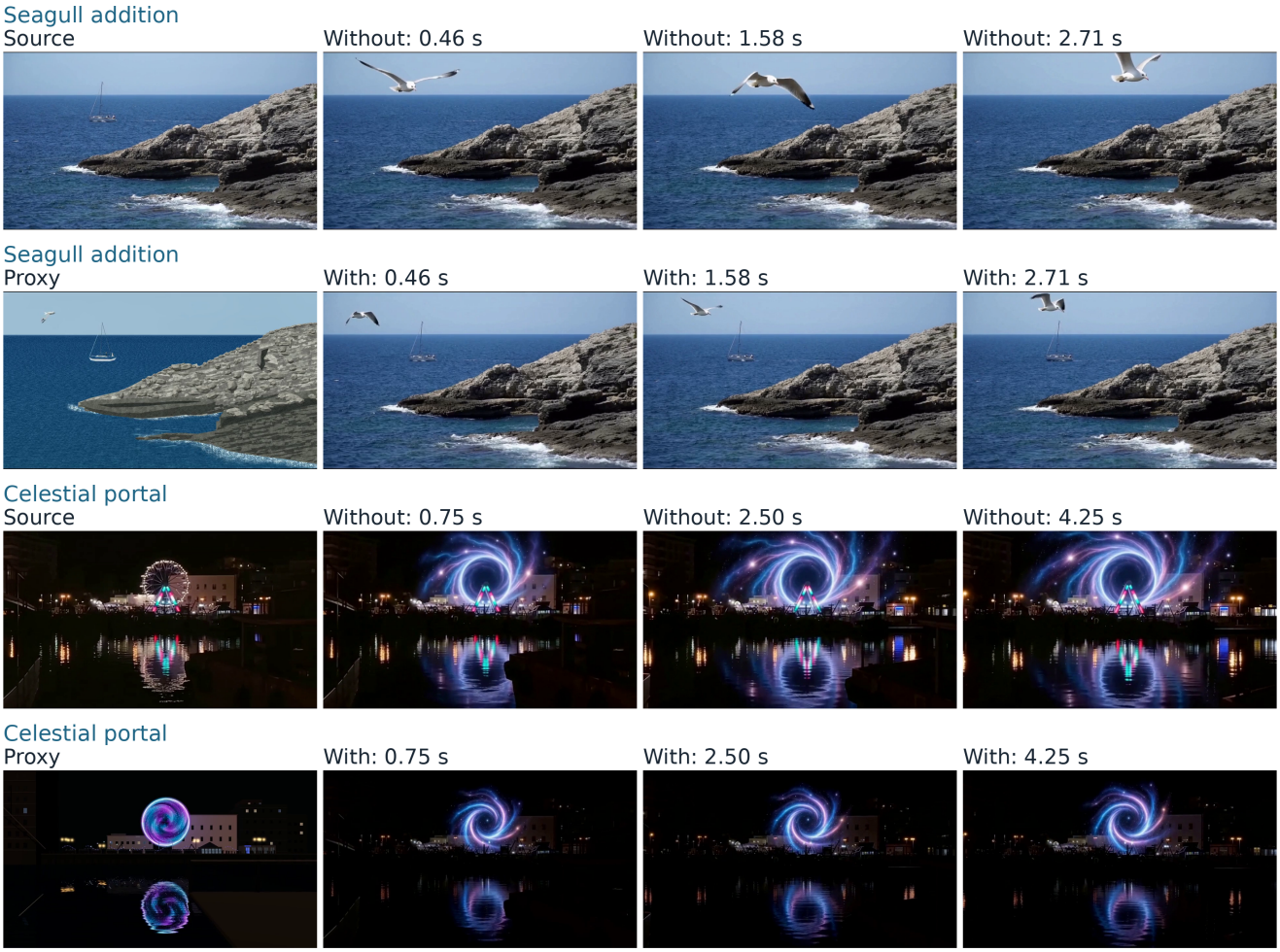

Figure 5. **Additional temporal views of existing showcase videos.** Each case has two rows: a source frame followed by three no-proxy timestamps, and a proxy frame followed by the matching guided timestamps. Top pair: seagull addition. Bottom pair: the celestial portal. All outputs are the same videos used in the gallery.

shot-by-shot target-video description. The numbered video references correspond to their actual input order.

> `source_reference_guidance:` `<Video 1>` is the source video to edit. Preserve its object identities, appearance, color palette, lighting, textures, material treatment, rendering medium, and overall aesthetic, as well as its composition, poses, spatial layout, motion, camera, shot transitions, and timing, except where the main edit prompt requires a change. `<Video 2>` is the structural proxy video showing the requested edit. Use `<Video 2>` as structural guidance for the requested edit; do not transfer its rendered appearance to the output. Follow the main edit prompt for the requested changes.

The edit request and reference-role text stay in the conditioning prompt throughout the trajectory. After step five, the proxy's visual reference and its associated multimodal conditioning are withdrawn as specified in Eq. (5). For requested stylization or appearance edits, the explicit exception in the preservation instruction allows the intended change. Source preservation is a conditioning objective rather than a pixelwise compositing constraint.

C. Additional Qualitative Results

C.1. Gallery protocol

The gallery uses the same training-free experiment as Table 1 and includes one successful example from each OpenVE-Bench editing task. The wall-clock addition example also appears in the method diagram. Candidates were shortlisted using existing scores and then inspected visually; the gallery is a selected capability illustration.

Each comparison shows the source, rendered proxy, no-proxy output, and early-step proxy-guided output at match-

ing timestamps. Both groups share the normalized source, main edit request, frozen model, seed 42, and 20 sampling steps. The source remains a reference throughout, with the proxy added for the first five steps in the guided group. All displayed frames preserve the complete normalized composition. Edit summaries are paraphrased for readability; the recorded generation prompts are unchanged.

C.2. Entity and spatial edits

Local addition. The seagull addition example places an animated bird in the upper-left sky. The procedural scene contains the coastline and boat as context, with the new bird placed above them. The output in Fig. 3 introduces the bird while retaining the recognizable rocky shore and sea. The clock example in Fig. 2 offers a complementary indoor addition: the proxy locates a new object relative to an existing person and wall. These examples show how an addition can be made explicit before synthesis. The no-proxy outputs introduce the requested objects but overshoot the planned scale or placement; the guided outputs follow the corresponding proxy plans more closely.

Local removal. The keyboard removal example targets the crescent-shaped keyboard surrounding a grand piano. The baseline retains this prominent keyboard ring. The proxy explicitly omits the ring while retaining the central piano, stage, and surrounding visual arrangement. The guided output follows this removal (Fig. 3), illustrating how the rendered target scene can make an omission concrete.

Local change. The person aging example replaces a woman with a silver-haired older woman while retaining her pose and position. Both output groups perform the age edit. The baseline additionally changes her white jacket into a dark dress and introduces a large necklace. The proxy-guided result retains the original outfit and phone action (Fig. 6). This comparison illustrates a more targeted intervention with fewer unrequested appearance changes.

Background change. The newsroom replacement example changes the background to a futuristic cyber command center. The baseline realizes the new environment but removes the foreground woman. The proxy includes both the speaker and the target surroundings, and the guided output retains her while changing the background. This example highlights the distinct roles of a requested background change and a foreground subject that should remain in the shot.

C.3. Camera and creative edits

Camera edit. The clock tower example requests a wide shot. The agent constructs the tower and surrounding context under the target framing. The no-proxy output remains close to the original medium view. In the guided output, the tower occupies less of the frame and more of the adjacent environment becomes visible (Fig. 7). The program makes the framing choice explicit through its camera and scene configuration. The requested wide composition applies to the edited shot; it is not an instruction to add a new reveal or a new cut.

Creative edit. The waterfront example transforms a Ferris wheel into a celestial portal. The proxy contains a luminous circular structure and its reflection, providing a spatially organized account of the transformation. The no-proxy result leaves elements of the wheel structure within the transformation. The guided result forms a coherent blue-violet portal in the waterfront setting with reflected light on the water. The example shows how procedural geometry and effects can communicate a creative target while the source supplies scene context.

C.4. Global style and subtitle edits

Global style. The portrait example requests a Pop Art treatment of a close-up profile. The proxy renders the face with graphic contours, flat colors, and halftone details. The baseline mainly applies saturated colors to photographic texture. The guided result adopts drawn contours and halftone details while keeping the profile composition recognizable (Fig. 8). Here, appearance changes are part of the instruction. The source-retention guidance is explicitly subordinate to those requested changes.

Subtitle edit. The aerial landscape example removes subtitles from the top of the frame. The no-proxy output retains the text band. The proxy depicts the scene without text, and the guided output removes the band while retaining the recognizable fields, mountains, and cloudy sky. The example uses the video generator for the final completion; no separate text-erasure or compositing operation is applied to the displayed output.

Temporal inspection. The examples are generated as videos rather than independent edited frames. Appendix Fig. 5 provides additional timestamps for the seagull and portal examples. These sequences expose the continuing edit and its relation to the original shot.

Figure 6. **Targeted edits with better source-content retention.** Top: both outputs age the woman, but the no-proxy result changes her clothing; proxy guidance retains the original white jacket. Bottom: the baseline generates an empty cyber command center, while the guided result retains the foreground speaker in the new environment.

Figure 7. **Reframing and creative transformation.** Top: the no-proxy output remains close to the source framing; the guided result realizes the requested wider shot of the clock tower. Bottom: the baseline blends a portal effect with the original wheel structure; the guided output forms a distinct celestial portal with a corresponding reflection.

Figure 8. **Stylization and subtitle removal.** Top: the portrait is rendered in a Pop Art aesthetic. The baseline mainly changes photographic colors, whereas the guided output adds graphic outlines and halftone detail. Bottom: the baseline retains the subtitle band, while proxy guidance removes it from the aerial landscape.

D. Evaluation and Diagnostic Details

Evaluator and video input. Table 1 uses the model identifier `google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview`, the official OpenVE-Bench task-specific rubric text and score parser, temperature 0.7, and a maximum output budget of 8,192 tokens. The judge receives the full original source MP4 and the generated output MP4 trimmed to the source's visible interval, together with the task rubric and original edit request. Videos are uploaded directly; evaluation does not use locally extracted contact sheets or selected frames. No explicit video-sampling FPS is requested from the API, so the service's internal temporal sampling is not controlled in this experiment. The 24 FPS normalization used for synthesis is distinct from this unspecified evaluator sampling rate. The proxy is not an input to the judge. The reported rubric scores assess visual editing; generated audio quality is not a separate metric.

Three judgments of each output. Each of 365 cases has two fixed generated outputs and three valid judgments per output, giving 2,190 successful scoring responses. An existing valid response is reused as the first judgment when available (729 responses in total); the remaining slots use additional API calls with the same video pair, model, instruction, and rubric. Failed responses remain in the run records and are excluded from score means. No best-of-three selection is performed. The three judgments concern the same generated video, not three different video samples.

Aggregation. Let $d^a_{i,r,j}$ be rubric dimension j of judgment r for case i and arm a, with $j, r \in \{1, 2, 3\}$. We retain the official parser's per-response rounding,

$$s^a_{i,r} = \mathrm{round}_2\left(\frac{1}{3}\sum_{j=1}^{3} d^a_{i,r,j}\right), \qquad \bar{s}^a_i = \frac{1}{3}\sum_{r=1}^{3} s^a_{i,r}. \quad (6)$$

For the common paired case set I_c of task c, the primary metric is

$$S^a_{\mathrm{macro}} = \frac{1}{8}\sum_{c=1}^{8}\frac{1}{|I_c|}\sum_{i\in I_c}\bar{s}^a_i. \quad (7)$$

The secondary micro score gives every case equal weight across the 365 pairs. We retain precision through repeat, task, and macro averaging, and round the displayed means to two decimals. The table's displayed differences subtract these displayed arm means, matching the existing visualization. All eight tasks have paired coverage, but their case counts differ. The 14 moderation skips and 52 unresolved program-generation or validation cases are outside this paired subset; no scores are imputed for them.

Diagnostic provenance. The diagnostic examples were shortlisted using the stored Gemini 3.1 scores and then inspected directly alongside the source, edited proxy, and both output groups at multiple timestamps. They are selected to make an observable synthesis limitation concrete. A proxy is considered informative here when the particular requested edit is visibly present; this does not imply perfect reconstruction of every source detail. Figure 9 shows that the retained bird and mixed snowflake/jellyfish transformation are visible at additional timestamps. The accompanying provenance records pin the scored MP4s, exact decoded frame indices, prompts, conditioning traces, and figure hashes.

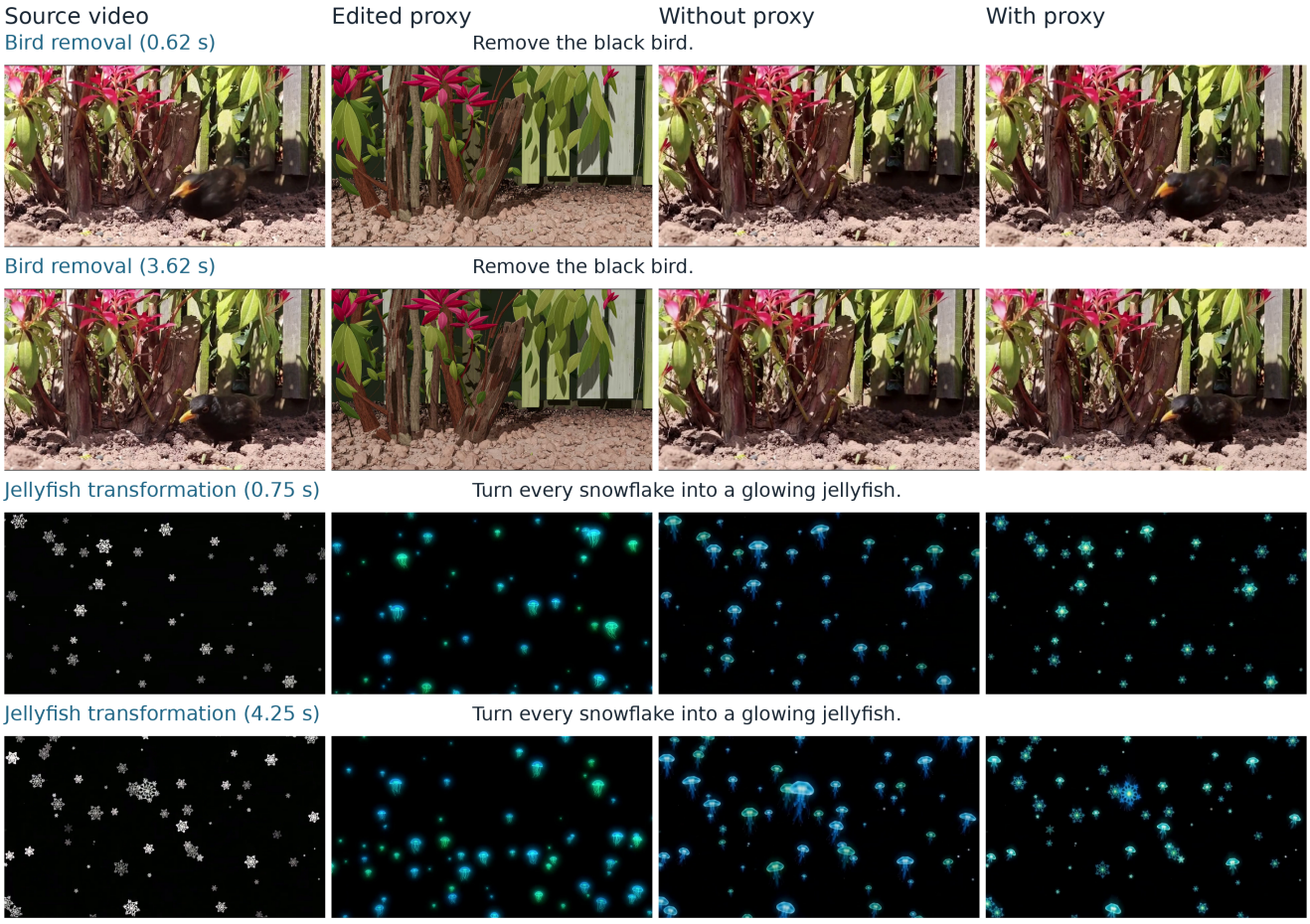

Figure 9. **Additional timestamps for diagnostic cases.** Top pair: the bird remains in the guided video although the proxy omits it. Bottom pair: the guided video mixes retained snowflakes with jellyfish, whereas the proxy depicts the intended transformed forms. All panels preserve the complete normalized composition and use the same videos as Fig. 4.